

Capable everywhere: Despite the batter-friendly conditions during IPL 2024, Axar Patel had a rewarding season with Delhi Capitals, claiming 11 wickets and scoring 235 runs. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR



India has a strong spin bowling line-up. How do you view the healthy competition among your fellow spinners?

It is essential. Without competition, complacency can set in, and you might start taking things for granted. In a competitive setting, I focus on my game and how I can improve. I don't concern myself with how others are batting or bowling; my focus remains on working hard on my own performance.

It's crucial to control what is within my power; otherwise, I'm not being fair to myself or my game. Constantly worrying about competitors will only hinder my growth.

Agar main constantly uss barein mein soch raha hoon, toh main

automatically haar raha hoon (If I am constantly thinking about it, then I am automatically losing).

With Gautam Gambhir as the new head coach and Suryakumar Yadav taking over as T20I captain, what's your plan for moving forward?

They will share their thoughts, and I will also express myself. Together, we will decide our roles, set targets, and approach things accordingly.

While people usually set targets, I don't set too many expectations and prefer to go with the flow.

When playing continuous cricket, it's important to keep asking yourself what's next and plan accordingly. Although there are long-term goals, I haven't set anything specific. Our primary goal was to win a World Cup, and having achieved that, we will now sit together to plan our future course of action.

« People often pigeonhole players into specific styles of play, but that's not accurate »